

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **A market rout** that dented nearly all asset classes following Friday's stronger-than-expected jobs report left investors with few places to hide as they enter a new week. **A1**
- ◆ **A consortium agreed** to buy Patrick Drahi's French telecommunications operations for more than \$23 billion in a deal that dismantles a major plank of the billionaire's once-sprawling business empire. **B1**
- ◆ **International businesses** are abandoning Cuba, delivering another blow to the island's collapsing economy as the Trump administration ratchets up pressure on Havana. **B1**
- ◆ **Run-A-Muck**, a media startup co-founded last year by traditional-media veterans from Hollywood and Manhattan, launched a newsletter and two umbrella media brands. **B3**
- ◆ **Ireland is requiring** new and expanded data centers to have their own power plants on site or contracts for new, largely renewable sources of energy to be produced nearby, helping to spare the public grid. **B1**
- ◆ **Electric dirt bikes**, or e-motos, have become the biggest source of young motorcycle riders since baby boomers fell for inexpensive Japanese dirt bikes in the 1960s and '70s. **B1**
- ◆ **A nationwide mechanics** shortage has prompted big employers such as Ford and philanthropic organizations to expand programs to persuade more workers to enter the trades. **B1**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Israel conducted** airstrikes against Iran in retaliation for missiles fired by Tehran, the first time the two countries targeted each other since a ceasefire went into effect in April. **A1**
- ◆ **OPEC and its allies** agreed to raise oil output in a move widely seen as symbolic as the war in the Middle East has choked off the Strait of Hormuz, through which a fifth of the world's oil passes. **A6**
- ◆ **Around 2,000 hospitality** workers at Los Angeles' SoFi Stadium voted to authorize a strike days before the start of the World Cup. **A3**
- ◆ **Amaryllis Fox Kennedy**, a former senior Trump administration official, said she resigned last month in part over the lack of oversight of the intelligence community's use of taxpayer funds. **A4**
- ◆ **Researchers said they** had edited the genes of early-stage human embryos, an intervention that could help fix disease-causing mutations in the code. **A3**
- ◆ **Ukraine launched** a mass drone attack on St. Petersburg a day after Putin gave a speech there rejecting a call for peace from Ukraine. **A8**
- ◆ **Nigeria's army said** it freed 360 people abducted by the Islamist group Boko Haram in the northeastern part of the country. **A6**
- ◆ **A 7.8-magnitude** quake struck off the Philippines' Mindanao island, prompting tsunami warnings. **A6**

JOURNAL REPORT

Best Companies for the Future: A new WSJ ranking. **R1-14**

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First-Time French Open Winner Floored by Feat



JUEN DE ROSA/ARRETTY IMAGES

COURT DRAMA: An emotional Alexander Zverev of Germany lies on his back Sunday after his five-set victory at tennis's French Open over Italy's Flavio Cobolli. Both Zverev and women's champion Mirra Andreeva of Russia are first-time major winners. **A14**

Israel Strikes Iran to Retaliate For Series of Missile Barrages

Foes target each other for first time since April; Trump's peace pleas rebuffed

By DOV LIEBER
AND ANAT PELED

TEL AVIV—Israel said Sunday it had launched airstrikes on Iran in retaliation for waves of missiles fired at its northern regions in a tumultuous day of renewed violence in

the Middle East that tested a fragile ceasefire.

Israel followed through on a promise to counterattack after Iran's missile assault, despite warnings to hold off from President Trump, who said a deal to end the war was near with Tehran. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu was under pressure from his political allies and the opposition to respond to the Iranian missile barrage.

Iran fired at least 10 missiles in four waves of attacks

on Sunday in response to a deadly Israeli airstrike on Beirut hours earlier targeting the Tehran-backed militant group Hezbollah. Israel said its air force struck military targets in central and western Iran in response, including air-defense systems and weapons, an Israeli official said.

Later Sunday, Israel said it was under attack from a ballistic missile launched from Yemen, likely by the Houthis, the Iran-backed militant group that runs much of that coun-

try. No injuries were reported.

The earlier exchange of strikes marks the first time Iran and Israel have targeted each other since a ceasefire brokered by the U.S. went into force in early April. The tit-for-tat threatens to escalate a conflict that has been largely contained since then, despite some lower-intensity skirmishes.

"The Iranian regime made a serious mistake," an Israeli military spokesperson said, adding that Israel would con-

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Employers Push Back On Weight-Loss Drugs

By RAY A. SMITH
AND PETER LOFTUS

Coverage for Ozempic and other drugs used for weight loss has fast become one of the most coveted workplace benefits—so much so that companies say they can no longer afford to provide it.

With as many as 1 in 8 American adults taking the pills or injectables, big employers from Cigna to PricewaterhouseCoopers are dropping coverage of so-called GLP-1s in droves. Others, like Chevron, are making workers jump through extra hoops to get coverage—and to ensure the drugs are used effectively—such as requiring mul-

tiple weigh-ins a month, meal-tracking on apps or sessions with an online health coach.

More than a quarter of big companies say they are adding criteria this year or next, while 11% have dropped or are planning to drop coverage for weight-loss purposes altogether, according to soon-to-be released data from benefits-advisory firm Mercer.

Globally, the portion of companies covering GLP-1s for weight loss has fallen to 23% this year from 30% in 2024, a new survey of more than 400 companies by the International Foundation of Employee Benefit Plans shows.

Under those circumstances, *Please turn to page A12*

INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
The new rebel motorcycle isn't a Harley—it's an electric dirt bike. **B1**

PERSONAL JOURNAL
From Gen Z to boomers, listeners are increasingly embracing throwbacks. **A11**

U.S. War Machine Leans on SpaceX

By DREW FITZGERALD
AND MICAH MAIDENBERG

SpaceX's years of courting the national-security establishment are paying off.

The U.S. government is SpaceX's largest single client, which the 24-year-old company identified as "Customer A" in securities filings ahead of its planned initial public offering. Revenue from the government, which totaled around \$4 billion in 2025, is set to sharply climb over the next few years.

The Elon Musk-led company has combined its ability to pump out satellites and quickly launch rockets with savvy maneuvering of the Pentagon to

Selloff Elicits Warnings Of More Turmoil

Wall Street is tested by inflation reading, flood of new shares; 'classic bubble stuff'

By GREGORY ZUCKERMAN
AND SAM GOLDFARB

Stocks. Bonds. Gold. Bitcoin. Investors enter the new week battered by a market selloff that left few places to hide.

The rout followed Friday's stronger-than-expected jobs report, which sheared 4.2% off the Nasdaq Composite Index, sent investors racing to increase bets that the Federal Reserve will raise interest rates by year-end and sparked a bond slide that lifted yields on some Treasuries to their highest levels since early 2025. That pressured shares of multinationals and smaller, domestic companies alike. Gold fell near its low of the year.

The tumble also drew warnings from Wall Street that more turmoil could lie ahead.

Bridgewater Associates founder Ray Dalio called Friday's tumble an "important" move that highlights the central role that the global craze for artificial intelligence and related stocks has played in the record run. With valuations stretched and yields rising, bonds are now much more attractively priced than stocks, leaving the market in a precarious position, even after Friday's fall, he said.

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◆ **Heard on the Street: Tech rally's pain points..... B8**

Wall Street's Hottest Trade: Knicks Tickets

It helps to know 'a guy'—or a banker

By DAVID UBERTI
AND GUNJAN BANERJI

Alex Todd has scored prime seats to Super Bowls, Stanley Cup Finals, the World Series and every New York Knicks playoff game this year besides their matchup on Mother's Day. He even snacked on caviar with friends and colleagues on a chartered jet to San Antonio to watch Game 1 of the NBA Finals.

But the Knicks die-hard has never seen anything as crazy as the race to watch the team Monday in its first finals game at home in 27 years.

A celebrity watch consultant, *Please turn to page A12*

The Cattle Empire Turned Ponzi Scheme

Investors and bank loans fueled 'house of cards' beef operations

By MARGOT PATRICK
AND PATRICK THOMAS

BENTON, Ky.—"There are two sides of me," Brian McClain scrawled on a piece of paper to his wife. One that loves you, he wrote. "The other that stole from people."

For years, McClain had kept cattle here in his hometown and on the Texas Panhandle, buying calves at auction and selling them for profit three months later. His 80,000-head operation—powered by a \$50 million loan from an agricultural bank and \$120 million from investors—appeared to be a blowout success for the former chemicals plant worker. He lived in a 4,100-square-foot brick home surrounded by a mani-

cured lawn, with gold-framed photos from his recent wedding in the entryway.

He also had a big secret: Most of the cattle were imaginary.

Once the lender got around to a physical check to count cattle and value McClain's collateral—the first full inspection after more than four years of sending him money—it enumerated only 8,916 animals.

In the end, the rancher burned through the \$170 million taken in from the bank and investors—some of them friends from his small Kentucky town. He managed to placate the bank when it occasionally raised concerns about financial figures that *Please turn to page A10*

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Agentic CRM

Based on G2 Grid Reports and verified customer reviews and ratings as of [February 2026].